

Aetna Medicare Part B Drug Step Criteria

Immunologics (MAPD plans)

Preferred product(s):

Cosentyx (secukinumab)

Enbrel (etanercept)

Humira (adalimumab)

Idacio (adalimumab-aacf)

Rinvoq (upadacitinib)

Skyrizi (risankizumab-rzaa)

Sotyktu (deucravacitinib)

Stelara (ustekinumab)

Tremfya (guselkumab)

Tyenne (tocilizumab-aazg)

Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib)

This criteria document informs prescribers of preferred products and provides an exception process for targeted products through prior authorization. Step criteria are applied in addition to any applicable National Coverage Determination (NCD), Local Coverage Determination (LCD), and Aetna Medicare Part B Drug Criteria. [Find Aetna Medicare Part B Drug Criteria documents.](#)

This program applies to immunologic products as specified in this policy. Coverage for targeted products is provided based on clinical circumstances that would exclude use of the preferred product and may be based on previous use of a product. The coverage review process will determine situations where a clinical exception can be made. This program applies to all Medicare members who are new to treatment with a targeted product.

For the indication(s) listed below (new starts only):

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Ankylosing spondylitis | 4. Psoriasis |
| 2. Crohn's disease | 5. Psoriatic arthritis |
| 3. Juvenile idiopathic arthritis | 6. Rheumatoid arthritis |

TABLE. Immunologics

Status	Product(s)
Preferred**	Cosentyx (secukinumab) Skyrizi (risankizumab-rzaa) Enbrel (etanercept) Sotyktu (deucravacitinib) Humira (adalimumab) Stelara (ustekinumab) Idacio (adalimumab-aacf) Tremfya (guselkumab) Rinvoq (upadacitinib) Tyenne (tocilizumab-aazg) Xeljanz/Xeljanz XR (tofacitinib)
Non-preferred (targeted)^	Actemra (tocilizumab) Riabni (rituximab-arrx) Avsola (infliximab-axxq) Rituxan (rituximab) Cimzia (certolizumab) Ruxience (rituximab-pvvr) Ilumya (tildrakizumab-asmn) Simponi Aria (golimumab) Tofidence (tocilizumab-bavi)

	Inflectra (infliximab-dyyb) Orencia (abatacept) Remicade (infliximab) Renflexis (infliximab-abda)	Truxima (rituximab-abbs) Tyruko (natalizumab-sztn) Tysabri (natalizumab) Unbranded infliximab
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* Preferred products are available through the Part D benefit and may still require a prior authorization review for medical necessity

^Products may not be indicated for all indications listed above

^Amjevita (adalimumab-atto), Bimzelx (bimekizumab-bkzx), Cimzia (certolizumab) and Olumiant (baricitinib) are also preferred on open formularies

7. Ulcerative Colitis

TABLE. Immunologics

Status	Product(s)
Preferred*	Entyvio IV (vedolizumab) Inflectra (infliximab-dyyb) Renflexis (infliximab-abda) Tremfya (guselkumab)
Non-preferred (targeted)	Avsola (infliximab-axxq) Omvoh (mirikizumab-mrkz) Remicade (infliximab) Unbranded infliximab

*Preferred products may still require a prior authorization review for medical necessity

EXCEPTION CRITERIA

Coverage for the targeted product(s) is provided when the member meets one or more of the following criteria:

1. Member has received the requested product in the past 365 days
2. Inadequate response to a trial of one or more of the preferred products
3. Intolerable adverse event to one or more of the preferred products
4. The preferred products are contraindicated for the member
5. The request is for a medically necessary indication not listed above

REFERENCES

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4. Ilumya (tildrakizumab-asmn) [prescribing information]. Cranbury, NJ: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries, Inc.; April 2023.
5. Inflectra (infliximab-dyyb) [prescribing information]. New York, NY: Pfizer labs; April 2023.
6. Infliximab [prescribing information]. Horsham, PA: Janssen Biotech, Inc.; October 2021.
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8. Orencia (abatacept) [prescribing information]. Princeton, NJ: Bristol-Myers Squibb Company; October 2023.
9. Remicade (infliximab) [prescribing information]. Horsham, PA: Janssen Biotech, Inc.; October 2021.
10. Renflexis (infliximab-abda) [prescribing information]. Jersey City, NJ: Organon LLC; December 2023.
11. Riabni (rituximab-arx) [prescribing information]. Thousand Oaks, CA: Amgen, Inc.; June 2022.
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14. Ruxience (rituximab-pvvr) [prescribing information]. New York, NY: Pfizer labs, Division of Pfizer Inc.; October 2023.
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17. Tofidence (tocilizumab-bavi) [prescribing information]. Cambridge, MA: Biogen MA Inc.; March 2025.
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20. Tyruko (natalizumab-sztn) [prescribing information]. Princeton, NJ: Sandoz Inc.; August 2023.
21. Tysabri (natalizumab) [prescribing information]. Cambridge, MA: Biogen Inc.; October 2023.
22. Entyvio (vedolizumab) [prescribing information]. Lexington, MA: Takeda Pharmaceuticals USA, Inc.; September 2023.
23. Enbrel [prescribing information]. Thousand Oaks, CA: Immunex Corporation; June 2022.
24. Humira [prescribing information]. North Chicago, IL: AbbVie Inc.; February 2024.
25. Rinvoq (upadacitinib) [prescribing information]. North Chicago, IL: AbbVie, Inc.; November 2023.
26. Skyrizi [prescribing information]. North Chicago, IL: AbbVie Inc.; January 2024.
27. Otezla (apremilast) [prescribing information]. Thousand Oaks, CA: Amgen Inc.; July 2023.
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DOCUMENT HISTORY

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See Evidence of Coverage for a complete description of plan benefits, exclusions, limitations and conditions of coverage. Plan features and availability may vary by service area.
The formulary may change at any time. You will receive notice when necessary.